ALKA MAHAPATRA

Product Designer & UX Researcher
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Product Designer and UX Researcher with 5+ years of experience translating customer and stakeholder insights into accessible web, mobile and enterprise experiences. Reduced workflow tracking errors by 18% and helped save enterprise clients an estimated $320K annually by simplifying complex product interactions. Bridges discovery research, usability testing, design systems and hands-on delivery to turn insights into usable solutions.

Relevant Work Experience

UX Consultant, Cocoon Technologies - USA (Remote) **Jul 2026 - Present**
- Simplified LARA's accessible traffic-stop flows from research to prototype and usability evaluation.
- Earned preference from 7 of 7 participants for the redesigned experience.
- Accelerated product validation with realistic prototypes and executive-ready demonstrations.

Product Designer & UX Researcher, Haptiq - New York **June 2025 - June 2026**
- Reduced enterprise workflow tracking errors by 18% by simplifying complex dashboards and product configuration.
- Saved enterprise clients an estimated $320K annually by translating research into actionable design decisions.
- Streamlined design-to-development handoff with reusable Figma patterns, clearer workflows and cross-functional validation.

UX Designer (Accessibility), Michigan Publishing - Michigan, USA **Feb 2025 - May 2025**
- Removed barriers in publishing experiences by prioritizing accessibility issues into usable developer guidance.
- Doubled assistive-technology compatibility through reusable accessibility standards.
- Clarified accessibility remediation priorities for product and engineering partners.

UX Lead & Manager, Transformative Ventures - India **Oct 2022 – May 2024**
- Led TAE's product UX work and mentored 3 designers across web and mobile customer journeys.
- Increased web conversion by 10.6% through research-informed experimentation.
- Strengthened cross-functional delivery by aligning Product, Engineering, Analytics and Marketing around research-driven design priorities.

UX Designer, Network for Conserving Central India - India **Jul 2022 – Sep 2022**
- Raised Lighthouse accessibility from 42 to 94 by reorganizing information architecture and site interactions.
- Reduced Time to Interactive by 3.5x with prioritized performance and accessibility fixes.

Associate UX/UI Designer, Kandle (formerly dRisk) - India **May 2022 – Jun 2022**
- Validated an early-stage fintech concept through responsive flows and a high-fidelity prototype for alpha onboarding.

Associate Graphic Designer, Trendgully - India **Mar 2022 – Apr 2022**
- Reduced design approval cycles by 25% through trend-led merchandise concepts and repeatable creative assets.

Senior Executive - Graphic Designer (10m), converted from Design Intern (4m), Blackberrys Menswear - India **Jan 2021 – Feb 2022**
- Reduced annual print-production costs by 62% by consolidating fragmented packaging and garment-tag information.
- Standardized cross-team production handoff and brand communication through consistent artwork specifications.

Research Analyst, Arvora - India **Nov 2020 – Dec 2020**
- Supported GI registration of Cuttack Rupa Tarakasi through artisan interviews and structured ethnographic research.

Graphic Design Intern, Odisha Crafts Museum - India **July 2019**
- Improved museum-program communication through visual and social content highlighting Odisha's craft heritage.

Education

- **Master of Science in Information (UX Research & Design),** University of Michigan - Ann Arbor **2024-2026**
  Focus: Interaction Design • User-Centered Design • Responsive Web • UX Research • Information Architecture • Accessibility | GPA: 4.0 / 4.0

- **Bachelor of Design,** National Institute of Fashion Technology - New Delhi **2017-2021**
  Focus: Fashion & Consumer Research • Visual Communication • Typography • Layout • Color • Graphic Design • Trend Research • Brand Storytelling • Photography • Product Development | GPA: 8.0 / 10.0

Award

Initiative Lead | Pitch2Win 2025 First Place, Thryve Health Management App **Oct 2025 – Nov 2025**
- Took a 0→1 AI-assisted health-management concept through secondary research, competitive benchmarking, value proposition, feature prioritization, TAM/SAM/SOM, pricing, business model, GTM, technology options, wireframes, AI prototype, branding, pitch development and financial modeling.
- Won 1st Place among 17 teams at Pitch2Win 2025.

Skills

- **UX Research:** User Interviews • Stakeholder Interviews • Surveys • Diary Studies • Contextual Inquiry • Ethnography • Usability Testing • Heuristic Evaluation • Competitive Analysis • Journey Mapping • Personas • Affinity Mapping • Research Synthesis • Qualitative & Quantitative Insights
- **Product & UX Design:** Product Discovery • Problem Framing • Information Architecture • User Flows • Interaction Design • Wireframing • High-Fidelity UI • Responsive Web • Native Mobile • Complex Workflows • Internal Tools • Dashboards • 0→1 Products
- **Experimentation & Analytics:** A/B Testing • Funnel Analysis • Behavioral Analytics • Heatmaps • Session Recordings • Conversion Optimization • GA4 • Hotjar • Microsoft Clarity
- **Design Systems & Delivery:** Figma • Auto Layout • Components • Variants • Variables • Component Properties • Responsive Patterns • Figma Dev Mode • Design QA • Developer Handoff • Agile
- **AI & Prototyping:** Claude • Claude Code • Cursor • ChatGPT • Gemini • Figma AI • Figma Make • Base44 • Lovable • v0 • Replit • GitHub Copilot
- **Technical & Creative:** Git/GitHub • VS Code • HTML/CSS • JavaScript Familiarity • Adobe Photoshop • Illustrator • InDesign • After Effects • ProtoPie • Rive • Miro • FigJam
- **Accessibility:** WCAG 2.2 AA • Section 508 • EN 301 549 • VPAT • VoiceOver • NVDA • TalkBack • Voice Access • Axe • WAVE